

DATA 422 Final Paper Rubric

Purpose: Assess a professional, conference-quality report demonstrating mastery of course goals: acquiring methodologies, applying techniques, independent research, technical communication, and applied problem-solving.

Category	A (Excellent)	B (Good)	C (Satisfactory)	D/F (Unsatisfactory)
Abstract & Intro	Concise summary of problem, methods, and results. Well-defined research question; motivates importance via research.	Good summary; minor detail missing. Context or research question(s) could be more focused.	Summary underdeveloped. Research question unclear or importance not established.	Abstract missing/inaccurate. Fails to define problem or provide context.
Lit Review & Methodology	Synthesizes high-quality research on "new topics." Effectively integrates coursework with novel methodologies.	Solid research. Utilizes coursework tools; novel method integration could be clearer.	Limited research. Sources listed, not synthesized. No novel methodologies explored.	Minimal/no research. Minimal or incorrect use of tools. Absent/incomplete.
Results	Focuses on primary solution. Uses visuals/metrics to show impact. Alternatives mentioned only for brief context.	Clear results, but narrative leans slightly too much on the "journey" over the solution.	Superficial analysis. Over-reliance on describing failed attempts. Lacks detail.	Minimal or absent results. Fails to provide clear analysis of project output.
Conclusions & Recommendations	Data-driven conclusions directly address research question(s). Actionable, "decision-quality" advice for sponsor.	Conclusions present, but connection to data or sponsor problem could be tighter.	Vague conclusions; does not follow from results. Recommendations generic or missing.	No clear conclusions or recommendations provided based on work.
Professionalism & Citations	All sources cited professionally (IEEE/APA). Writing is cogent, formal, and error-free. Conference standard.	Minor formatting errors. Mostly accurate/formal; some areas need clarity or thoroughness.	Inconsistent citations. Significant gaps in professionalism, clarity, or formality.	Citations absent. Poorly organized, sloppy, or incomplete.